FRAMESHIFT / THE PRACTICAL DESIGN LIBRARY

Backyard Swimming Pool

A design brief, procurement and safety-planning workbook

This is a planning guide for homeowners considering a swimming pool. The FrameShift backyard-pool film is an AI concept, not evidence that an excavation, engineering design, water test or safety inspection has occurred.

- □ WHO THIS IS FOR: homeowners, tenants seeking permission, design clients and people preparing to interview contractors.
- □ WHAT IT IS: an educational planning resource with a clear brief, staged questions and printable worksheets.
- □ WHAT IT IS NOT: an engineered drawing set, statutory approval, DIY method statement, permit, warranty or proof that the filmed work actually happened.

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Start with the brief

Complete these fields before requesting quotations. Work quality improves when every contractor is pricing the same scope.

Project address / city	_____
Owner / landlord permission	_____
Project goals (top 3)	_____
Existing problems / damage	_____
Budget ceiling and currency	_____
Target start / completion	_____
Must-keep features	_____
Decision maker / contact	_____

Universal pre-project checklist

- □ Identify the exact property and intended use; confirm whether you own the property or need landlord, homeowners' association or building-management consent.
- □ Take clear dated before photos, measure dimensions, note door/window clearance, and record existing damage or moisture problems.
- □ Obtain at least two itemised written quotations with materials, exclusions, schedule, payment milestones and warranty information.
- □ Check the relevant authority and building rules for the actual location. Online US or European references are useful questions to raise, not automatic local legal requirements.
- □ Never treat an AI video as documentation that any work was physically performed, inspected or tested.

1 / Feasibility before drawings

□ Obtain property survey, access constraints, setbacks, utility locations and any relevant easements before discussing dimensions.

□ Ask local authorities whether approvals and inspections are required for excavation, drainage, structures, fencing, plumbing and electrical work.

□ Discuss soil conditions, groundwater, proximity to foundations and necessary engineering investigations with competent professionals.

□ Check how excavated material will be removed and whether plant can safely reach the proposed pool area.

2 / Define the swimming experience

□ Write down who will use the pool, supervision arrangements, preferred activities, maintenance appetite and approximate available space.

□ Compare pool shape, finish, depth concept, steps, accessible access, shading, decking and landscape integration with a designer.

□ Have qualified designers calculate structural, hydraulic and water-treatment requirements; do not substitute generic DIY dimensions or online formulas.

□ Specify where equipment, pumps, filtration, backwash/discharge and service access will be placed.

3 / Contractor scope and risk control

□ Request a drawing set and an itemised quotation that identifies excavation, soil support, concrete/structure, waterproofing, finish, hydraulic systems, electrical work and site restoration.

□ Clarify who owns the design and coordination between pool shell, plumbing, equipment pad, bonding/earthing and electrical protection.

□ Confirm protection against unauthorized access during construction and after opening, with compliant barriers and latching gates as applicable.

□ Agree hold-points before concrete, backfill, final finishes and opening for use; insist on site-specific documented inspections.

4 / Safety and operations

□ Review a multilayer water-safety plan: supervision, barriers, alarms/covers where appropriate, rescue equipment and emergency readiness.

□ Ensure qualified specialists assess suction and entrapment hazards, equipment/cover selection, electrical hazards and bonding/earthing.

□ Request a water treatment and monitoring plan, owner training and a maintenance schedule before first use.

□ Do not regard AI imagery, marketing claims or a brief filmed 'test' as proof of construction compliance or safe water.

5 / Handover checklist

- □ Collect as-built plans, applicable inspection signoffs, commissioning records, equipment manuals, guarantees and emergency contacts.
- □ Receive a demonstration of the filtration, isolation switches, cleaning, water testing and shutdown procedures.
- □ Walk through gates, barriers, visibility/supervision sightlines, deck trip/slip risks and all owner duties.
- □ Confirm a warranty/defect process and a staged payment closeout tied to verified deliverables.

Budget worksheet

Enter your local quotes and currency. No prices here are represented as accurate quotes for your location. Add a contingency suitable to the project and seek professional advice on unforeseen conditions.

Category	Quote / currency	Notes / exclusions
Survey and feasibility	_____	_____
Permits / engineering	_____	_____
Excavation / spoil disposal	_____	_____
Pool structure and shell	_____	_____
Waterproofing and internal finish	_____	_____
Plumbing / pump / filtration	_____	_____
Electrical / safety systems	_____	_____
Decking and landscape	_____	_____
Fencing / barriers	_____	_____
Testing / commissioning / contingency	_____	_____
TOTAL	_____	_____

Ask the contractor before signing

- □ Who is the licensed/qualified engineer of record?
- □ How will underground services and soil conditions be checked?
- □ How will suction, electrical bonding and barrier safety be documented?
- □ What specific commissioning tests and certificates will be provided?
- □ Who trains the owner on safe water care and equipment?

Quote comparison

Contractor A / price / dates	
Contractor B / price / dates	
Scope difference / exclusions	
Licences / insurance checked	
References checked / follow-up	
Chosen contractor / why	

Before you sign off

- □ Scope and variations are itemised in writing
- □ Approval and technical signoffs appropriate for the site are collected
- □ Photographs and receipts for concealed or regulated works are retained
- □ Owner receives product manuals, maintenance instructions and warranties
- □ Defects list and remedy date are agreed
- □ Final payment milestones and retention are clarified in the signed contract
- □ AI-concept imagery is never used as evidence of work carried out

Further reading and source notes

CPSC — Safety Barrier Guidelines for Home Pools

https://www.cpsc.gov/safety-education/safety-guides/pools-and-spas/safety-barrier-guidelines-home-pools

CPSC — Pool Safely Education

https://www.cpsc.gov/Safety-Education/Safety-Education-Materials

EPA — remodeling indoor-air quality

https://www.epa.gov/indoor-air-quality-iaq/best-practices-indoor-air-quality-when-remodeling-your-home

Important scope notice

Different countries and municipalities use different codes, licences, permit processes and construction standards. The cited reference materials are educational starting points, not a statement that a particular standard legally governs your project. Structural, electrical, excavation, fall protection and water-safety decisions must be approved and performed by appropriately qualified local professionals.

FrameShift Transformations — Every space has a second story.